

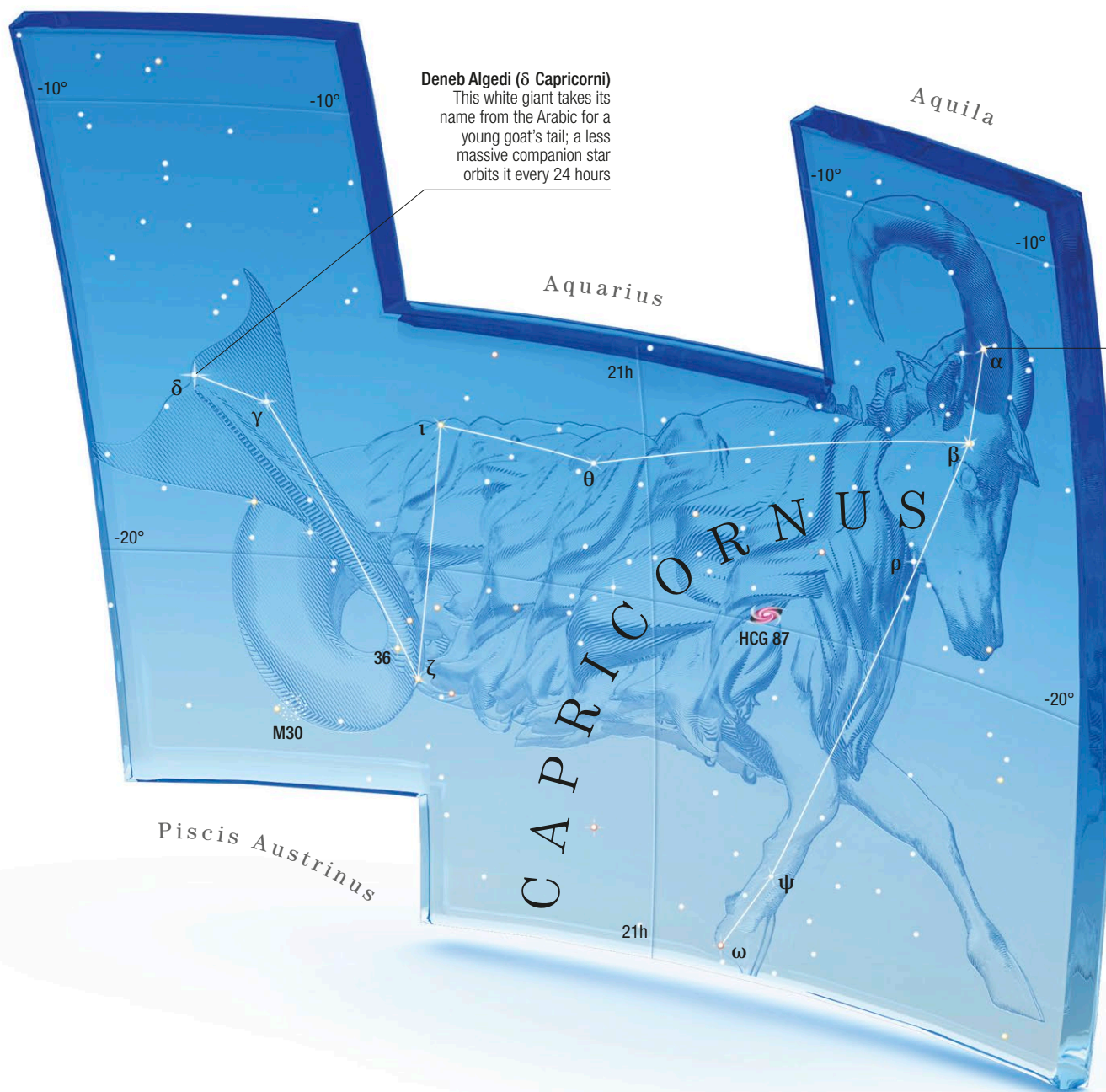
CAPRICORNUS

THE SEA GOAT

THE SMALLEST CONSTELLATION OF THE ZODIAC, CAPRICORNUS DEPICTS A STRANGE CREATURE THAT IS HALF GOAT AND HALF FISH. IT LIES BETWEEN SAGITTARIUS AND AQUARIUS AND CONTAINS SOME INTERESTING STARS.

The ancient Greeks linked Capricornus with one of their gods, the goatlike Pan, who turned his lower body into that of a fish and hid in a river to escape the monster Typhon. Capricornus lacks bright clusters and nebulae and its galaxies are mostly too faint to be seen with small telescopes but it

has stars that can be seen with amateur equipment. Alpha Capricorni is an impressive pair of unrelated stars: a yellow supergiant (Alpha¹, or Algedi Prima) and an orange giant (Alpha², or Algedi Secunda). A small telescope reveals that Alpha¹ is itself a double, and a larger telescope that Alpha² is a triple star.



Deneb Algedi (δ Capricorni)
This white giant takes its name from the Arabic for a young goat's tail; a less massive companion star orbits it every 24 hours

KEY DATA

Size ranking	40
Brightest stars	Deneb Algedi (δ) 2.8, Dabih (β) 3.1
Genitive	Capricorni
Abbreviation	Cap
Highest in sky at 10pm	August–September
Fully visible	62°N–90°S

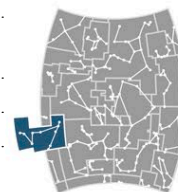


CHART 4

MAIN STARS

Algedi Secunda Alpha² (α²) Capricorni
Orange giant and triple star

☼ 3.6 ↔ 105 light-years

Dabih Beta (β) Capricorni
Yellow giant and multiple star

☼ 3.1 ↔ 327 light-years

Deneb Algedi Delta (δ) Capricorni
White giant and eclipsing binary star

☼ 2.8 ↔ 37 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M30
Globular cluster

HCG 87 (Hickson Compact Group 87)
Compact group of galaxies

Algedi (α Capricorni)
An optical double consisting of the yellow supergiant Algedi Prima (α¹) and the orange giant Algedi Secunda (α²)

Sagittarius



△ **HCG 87 (Hickson Compact Group 87)**
Three of the four galaxies known as HCG 87 are so close that they are affected by their mutual gravity. A faint tidal bridge of stars links the disk-shaped galaxy seen edge-on (bottom center), to its nearest neighbor, an elliptical galaxy (bottom right). The third, the spiral galaxy at the top of the image, is undergoing intense star formation. The small spiral galaxy near the center may be far in the distance.